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7.1 LINTELS AND ARCHES

Learning Objectives

At the end of this lesson you shall be able to

- Understand the types of lintels and arches.
- Differentiate lintels and arches.

7.1.1 Lintel - Introduction

A lintel is a horizontal member which is placed across the openings like doors, windows, etc., in buildings. Lintels takes the load from the structure above it and provides support to it. Lintel is also a type of beam. The width of lintel is equal to the width of wall and the ends are built into the wall. These are very easy to construct when compared to arches.

Bearing of Lintel

The bearing of lintels should be provided as follows.

1. 10 cm to 20cm
2. Height of lintel beam
3. $1/10^{th}$ to $1/12^{th}$ of span of the lintel

7.1.2 Types of Lintels used in Building Construction

Lintels are classified based on the material used for the construction as:

1. Timber Lintel
2. Stone Lintel
3. Brick Lintel
4. Steel Lintel
5. Reinforced Concrete Lintel
6. Reinforced Brick Lintel

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